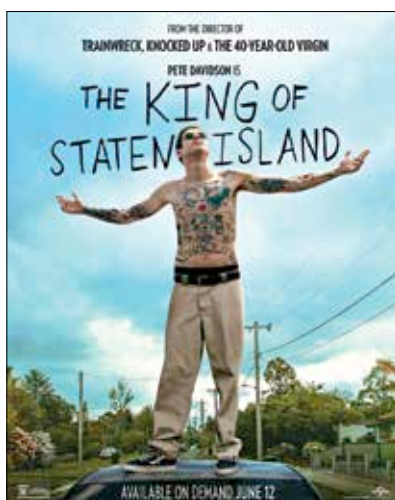


MOVIE

The King of Staten Island

★★★★☆ | Dark comedy is pretty rare to see these days. Not because it is difficult to pull off or anything. But because it touches upon and ridicules sensitive issues, which does not sit well with the humanitarian media. In cases such as this, it is generally considered safe to hit the middle ground. And this is where Pete Davidson's semi-autobiographical dramedy succeeds.

Directed by Judd Apatow, *The King of Staten Island* follows the story of Scott (Pete Davidson), a guy in his early twenties, trying to figure out his life while also dealing with trauma from his father's death at a young age. This film is sort of a detailed character study on a loser with no sense of direction, but big dreams, who also makes a few bad decisions along the way. The film has a decent script with great jokes and it implements social



themes into it with style. Unlike other films where themes of depression are characterised by black hoodies and antidepressants, this one takes a more realistic route. Some of the highlights in this film are self-loathing, lack of motivation, jealousy (here: sibling rivalry), masking emotions, sudden fits of rage and using humour as a coping mechanism. The humour in this film inclines towards frat boy humour coupled with some insensitive jokes here and there. Now, granted, all

the jokes may not be LMAO worthy, but most of them are clever and are sure to trickle a chuckle out of you. Pete Davidson does an amazing job in the film, despite not being from a film background. His character feels convincing and relatable. Although one could argue that Pete is just playing himself in this film, with minor story changes here and there, his character just feels natural and does not stand out amongst the rest of the cast, who were equally exceptional. The cinematography and editing in this film is solid with gorgeous thematic lighting, plenty of camera angles and in-sync cuts that maintain the pace and highlights every characters' expressions.

Overall, *The King of Staten Island* is a fun movie about an average millennial trying to find his purpose in life. It has got a touching story with funny moments, great performances from the actors and solid cinematography. The only downside would be that it dragged on for too long (137 minutes), which is not technically a horrible thing considering it offered ample content as well. All in all, a great film that is definitely worth checking out.

ANIME MOVIE

Konosuba – Legend of Crimson

★★★★☆ | Those who have watched *Konosuba* will already know what they're in for before starting this movie. Those who haven't watched it should probably do that first. *Konosuba*, for the uninitiated, stands for *Kono Subarashii Sekai ni Shukufuku wo!*, which is ridiculously long, so it's been abbreviated to *Konosuba*. It translates to God's blessing on this wonderful world, but it's everything but a blessing, for said world. This is one of the best isekai parodies out there, complete with all the generic tropes,



fourth wall breaking, over the top character personalities and more.

We're not here to talk about the show though, we're talking about

the new movie. The new movie is basically a 1.5 hour long episode. Basically more of the same. Which we're more than happy with. Many had qualms about the quality of animation, which seems to have taken a slight drop, but we didn't think it was that much of an issue. The story revolves around the Crimson Demon Clan, which is where Megumin comes from, who is a part of the MC (main character's) party. They're basically a clan of spell-slinging mages who only care for flash. Turns out, their biggest weakness is sealed right next to them, and somehow, of course, Kazuma (MC) manages to release it. Every character gets their time to shine, except maybe Aqua, which could possibly be intentional... Moving on, the show is a bit notorious for its fanservice, and that definitely carries over to the movie, so keep that in mind when you're watching as well.